

OREGON CITY COURIER

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DEVELOPMENT

One of the curious things about the section of the county immediately surrounding the county seat is that two-thirds of the people seem to be highly interested in development along all lines but one. The citizens get wildly enthusiastic when a new railroad is mentioned and they have hysterics of joy if the mentioned railroad actually materializes. If somebody threatens to establish a new industry the Commercial club has a fit of congratulation, and everybody promises to support the industry when its wheels get to turning. If some stranger blows into the community and offers to buy a hundred acres of land, and says he is going to improve and develop it, there is a glad song of triumph goes up from all corners of the county. Development is great stuff, and every booster knows it.

However, when some humble individual rises in his place and says that he believes something ought to be done for the boys and girls of the community, the spirit of development quickly spreads its wings and soars off to Timbuctoo or some other distant locality. Yet when one gets down to cases, what better "development" work can there be than giving the boys and girls of today a better chance to make better men and women of tomorrow.

The Courier is moved to touch again upon this subject because Christmas is coming—and for some other reasons. But primarily on account of Christmas, which is supposed to be the season of the year when people open their hearts and to a less degree their purses. And also because the Christmas season is the time when our thoughts naturally turn towards children. We all want the children to be happy on Christmas; our own children first, of course, and then other people's children.

For years Oregon City has been making spasmodic efforts at establishing some sort of a recreation center for young people. At times the different churches have gotten behind the movement, and at other times there has been an effort to get a municipal playground established. To date all these efforts have failed, but the people who have been back of them have not been utterly discouraged. Two of the local churches, determined at least to look after their own children, have established some form of recreation centers for the young; and the glad news was handed out here not very long ago that the high school was eventually to have a real gymnasium.

However, a school gymnasium, unless it be thrown open to all children at other times than during school hours, is not sufficient. Oregon City should at least have a public playground. It would be better yet if it could have a public gymnasium, which would be available to children in the rainy season. Not only should Oregon City have such a gathering place, but every community in the county should have such a place. The last move in this direction failed—the effort of Gladstone to establish a gymnasium in its school. The Gladstone voters who turned this down doubtless had their reasons; but nevertheless it was a mistake for the voters to have gone against the plan.

Nearly every community in this county has some vacant building; a barn, a loft or a warehouse, which has

been standing idle for some time. It would be a superb Christmas gift if the owner of such a building would turn it over to the community, rent free, as a recreation center. If this initial move was made, other public spirited citizens could easily be found who would care for the other needs. Gymnastic apparatus could be procured, a volunteer leader could be prevailed upon to give more or less time. The children themselves would be glad to scurry about and gather fuel for heating places, and probably lights for the evening could be secured with little effort and practically no expense.

Just once let a recreation center be established and the rest would follow. People would see that something was being done to give boys and girls some relief from the monotony of the life they lead at present—story-hours, play hours, mild gymnastics, anything to bring out the true spirits of boys and girls. The thing that is needed is some encouragement for young boys and girls to develop character and originality; to teach them to play healthfully, to wean them away from the attractions of the usual loafing places and to get them off the streets.

It isn't much to ask, is it—developing character and life in our boys and girls? Wouldn't it be a nice Christmas gift to the community? Wouldn't it be real DEVELOPMENT, better than railroads, factories or subdivided property? Wouldn't it be REALLY WORTH WHILE?

Think about it you who read this, and see if you can't find some way to make this Christmas more than any other Christmas has ever been in your community—see if you can't do something to bring a feeling of fellowship and interest into the hearts of the boys and girls who now have no other place to go than the streets after the school hours are done.

AGAIN WE REMARK

This is the time of the year when mother sits up till midnight sewing crocheted uppers onto a pair of leather soles for father's Christmas slippers, and when she doesn't get puffed when dad comes home late and says he was detained at the office. This is also the time of the year when father begins to wonder if it is a square deal for him to have to give mother fifty dollars to buy Christmas presents for the family, and then have to cough up another fifty of his own to duplicate the job for presents that he will give the family.

This is also the time of the year when mysterious packages are hidden in the closets, under the beds and beneath the bathtub, and when shawls, dressing gowns, handkerchiefs and other light articles are placed between the blankets and the comforters so that prying eyes will not find them until they are hung on the Christmas tree. In other words this is the period of the year immediately preceding Christmas, when everybody is broke, and when everybody wishes that the pretty things in the stores didn't cost so much.

This is also the time of the year when the hanging baskets on the front porch and the flower boxes beside the doorstep have to be taken in every night so that they won't freeze if a frost should come along. It is also the season of the year when children like to go downtown and look in the store windows, and when shopkeepers have to smile at little boys

and girls who get into the top departments of the various stores and paw over all the mechanical trains, bugs, automobiles and gunboats that they would like to have Santa Claus bring them.

It is likewise about this time of the year when there comes in the mail and in other ways a flood of begging letters and opportunities to give our money for the cheering up of the poor during the merry Yule season. The Salvation army, the Muts, the charities and the churches, and also a few people who want to do good with other folks' money, all drop around and invite us to contribute all we can afford for the benefit of strangers who are just a little bit poorer than we are. It is a great time of the year.

It is also the time of the year when we get used to mud or else buy high shoes that make us look like lumberjacks, and limp around until we get them softened up. By that time the rain usually ceases, and we have the shoes on our hands. It is also the season of the year when all our relatives, who haven't written to us since their daughters got married, drop us a line so that we will know their address. We make note of the address, and send them a Christmas card.

This is also the time of the year when we write editorials like this, because we are so busy trying to figure out how we can make both ends meet in our own Christmas shopping that we haven't enough brain energy left to write any heavy stuff about the tariff or the war in Europe. And anyway, stuff like this is just about as good.

THE NEW MAYOR

The Courier congratulates the new mayor, who will rule over the destinies of the county seat after the first

lection. Undue economy in these two departments will not be economy at all; and the Courier believes that even more money than is now allowed might well and "economically" be spent in these two departments.

The Courier wishes the new mayor success, and trusts that in his administration of the city affairs he will fulfill the desires and hopes of the citizens who honored him with their votes. Being mayor of a city is a high office, it is an office of honor and hard work, and the man selected to be thus the city's most important public servant should never forget that he holds office at the will of the people, and that he is responsible directly to the people's will.

IT'S ABOUT TIME

Daily papers last week informed us that initial steps had been taken in Chicago for the formation of a co-operative association of farmers, which would eventually embrace within its scope the six million farmers who are the backbone of the United States. It is about time that the American farmer got together with himself and realized his own power.

For many years the farmer, owing to lack of organization, has been at the mercy of business organizations with which he has had to deal. Organized buyers quoted him any price that they were willing to pay for the farmers' product; and organized selling associations dictated to him the price he must pay for the things that he needed to continue farming. Aside from the food he could raise or get from his neighbors, the farmer has been up against some form of "trust" every time he paid out a penny for anything.

If he bought farm machinery, he was up against the harvester com-

but much more beautiful exposition is still holding its attractions open to the public, and financially it has been just as much of a success as the affair at the Bay City.

San Francisco is now showing a tendency to plout at what it has accomplished. This would be perfectly proper were it not for several things. The Frisco exposition started in as a "spite show," and since it has been open it has taken onto itself airs that have been altogether too arrogant. To read the publicity sent out by the Frisco fair, one would think that it was the only exposition that the Pacific slope ever pulled off. If it had been, the gloating and hysteria might be more excusable.

But as a matter of fact, the Frisco fair was an afterthought sprung when the San Diego idea was already struggling to maturity. The Frisco fair was launched in a spirit of jealousy when San Francisco found that its southern neighbor was likely to attract the attention of the world. San Francisco made every effort to kill off the San Diego show, and when it failed in that, it tried to outshine by pure garishness the beauty of the Southern California display, which was a real work of art. So right at the start, San Francisco had no reason to strut about.

In addition to this, the San Francisco exposition was not the first to be held on the Coast. There was one at Portland, which astounded the world, and there was one at Seattle which shared with the Lewis & Clarke fair the admiration of all beholders. Both of these fairs—the one in Oregon and the one in Washington, were staged and successfully held with far less capital invested than was at the beck and call of San Francisco in her effort to outshine the universe. Hence it would appear that San Francisco



Dear Amy:-

John and I have already sent two easy chairs for Christmas to Grandma and Grandpa, and you ought to read the letter they wrote back. They said they knew their children were sensible as well as thoughtful, because they sent such sensible presents. They never got anything in their lives that pleased them so well.

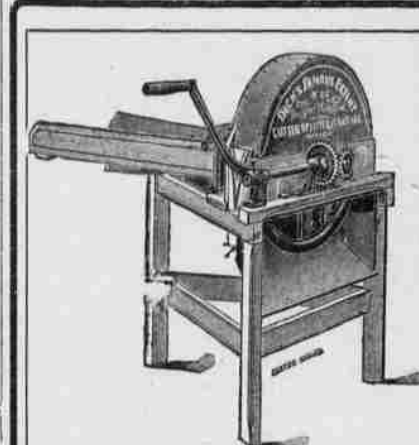
As ever,
Lou.

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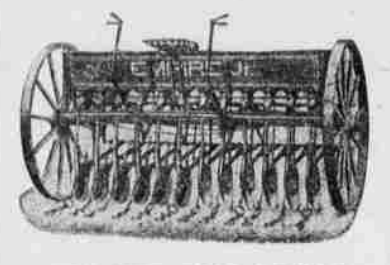
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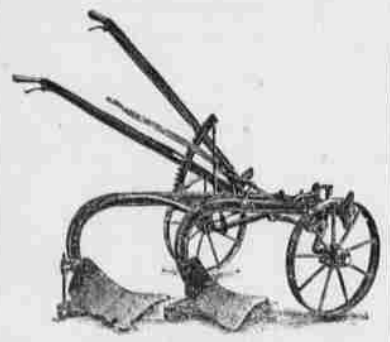
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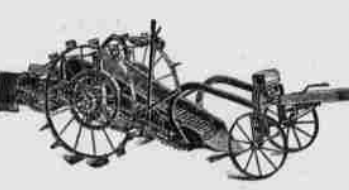
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thinking about. And when local businessmen do new things, or change their methods, accounts of the facts are news.

The Courier merely mentions this here so that some of its critics will know that the Courier is doing this deliberately, and that it isn't permitting some outsider to "slip something over on it." We have been told that four articles which have appeared in four recent issues of the Courier are "press agent work"; we are one of the nicest little press agents in this neck of the woods. And as for "falling" for them—well, the Courier usually "falls" for the stuff that members of its own staff write. That is what they are paid for, and that is what the Courier is run for.

Any person who doesn't like to read about business development in this community can simply pass over such articles—but please don't try to tell the Courier that it doesn't know "press agent stuff" when it sees it. That's about all, thank you!

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of the year, and who will preside at the sessions of the reorganized council. Not having taken any part in the campaign at all, the Courier is able to congratulate the winner with more sincerity than might be the case if it had shown partisanship during the weeks before election. The people have spoken and expressed their choice, and as the people are the ones who will have most dealings with the mayor, it is to be hoped that they are as well satisfied as is the Courier with the outcome of the election.

The mayor-elect will go into office with considerable experience in handling municipal affairs. His former efforts in the council, and his regular presence at the sessions of the city fathers, will have familiarized him with the game as it is played in the county seat, and probably the mayor will therefore have a full sympathy with the councilmen and their efforts to please. And as the mayor, during his councilmanic career, was not in any way spectacular or radical in his actions; a "safe and sane" administration may be expected.

The new mayor enters his official duties with a pledge of strict economy in regard to the administration of city affairs. It is surely time for economy; but in cutting expenses to the bone, the Courier trusts that the new city executive will not deprive the county seat of the things that it really needs—such as ample police protection and more extensive fire pro-

tection. Undue economy in these two departments will not be economy at all; and the Courier believes that even more money than is now allowed might well and "economically" be spent in these two departments.

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THE DIFFERENCE

Last Saturday the Panama-Pacific International exposition at San Francisco came to an end. Financially the show was said to have been a success; and as an exposition it is reported to have ranked among the best. Down at San Diego a smaller

ought to look beyond her own confines, at other expositions, and then put on the soft pedal a bit.

It is true that San Francisco, in recovering from the devastation of earthquake and fire, did a wonderful thing, and that in staging her exposition so soon after disaster she showed a Western pluck that was well worthy of the greatest praise. But San Francisco does not gloat at that—she lacks the true Western modesty of achievement. She just gloats—unreasonably and arrogantly. And that is not Western in spirit, and will not make San Francisco any more beloved on the Pacific coast.

TELLING THE TRUTH

Recently the Courier has had some two or three articles dealing with business matters in the county seat. One of the articles told why drug prices were higher than formerly, one told of a new industry that an Oregon City businessman had established, and another told of new shopping methods that had been inaugurated in Oregon City department stores. The articles were all prepared by members of the Courier staff, and according to the policy of this paper were perfectly legitimate.

The Courier will probably have some more articles of a similar vein. This paper believes in telling its readers what the people of Clackamas county are doing and what they are